

STUDY NOTES · UPSSSC PET 2026

UPSSSC PET General English

सम्पूर्ण अंग्रेजी नोट्स — Grammar, Vocabulary, Sentence Ability & Comprehension

4 अध्याय-फाइल
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General English — Basic Grammar

PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

Learning sequence: Concept → Rule → Examples → Common Errors → Exam Tip → Practice

Hindi Help: कठिन या confusing points पर ही short Hindi support दिया जाएगा। बाकी explanation English में रहेगा।

Part A — Parts of Speech

Parts of speech classify words according to their grammatical function in a sentence. A word must be identified from its **context and function**.

Part	Function	Examples
Noun	names a person, place, thing, animal, quality, or idea	teacher, Delhi, honesty
Pronoun	stands for/refers to a noun or noun phrase	he, she, they
Adjective	modifies/describes a noun or pronoun	honest, tall, three
Verb	expresses action, occurrence, or state	run, write, seem
Adverb	modifies a verb, adjective, adverb, or clause	quickly, very, often
Preposition	expresses a relationship	in, on, between
Conjunction	connects words, phrases, or clauses	and, but, because
Interjection	expresses sudden feeling	Oh!, Alas!
Article	marks a noun as general/specific	a, an, the

Core Concept

Context matters:

- **Fast** is an adjective in “a fast car”.
- **Fast** is an adverb in “He runs fast”.

💡 Exam Tip

Hindi Help: Part of Speech = sentence में word का grammatical function.

Part B — Nouns

A **noun** names a person, place, thing, animal, substance, quality, state, or idea.

Types of Nouns

- **Proper:** Rahul, India, Monday
- **Common:** boy, country, city
- **Collective:** team, committee, crowd
- **Abstract:** honesty, beauty, courage
- **Material:** gold, water, milk
- **Countable:** book, apple, student
- **Uncountable:** advice, information, furniture, luggage

⚠ Warning

Do not normally write **advices, informations, furnitures, luggages** in standard English.

Use: **a piece of advice, some information, a piece of furniture.**

Number

- Singular: book, child, woman
- Plural: books, children, women

Important Irregular Plurals

Singular	Plural
man	men
woman	women
child	children
foot	feet
tooth	teeth
mouse	mice
person	people

Possessive Nouns

- Rahul's book
- the boys' bags
- the children's toys

⚠ Trap

Some words ending in **-s** can be singular in meaning: **news, mathematics**. Always judge from the sentence.

Part C — Pronouns

A **pronoun** is used in place of, or to refer to, a noun/noun phrase.

Types

Type	Examples
Personal	I, we, you, he, she, it, they
Possessive	mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs
Reflexive	myself, yourself, himself, herself, themselves
Demonstrative	this, that, these, those
Relative	who, whom, whose, which, that
Interrogative	who, whom, whose, which, what
Indefinite	someone, anyone, nobody, each, several
Reciprocal	each other, one another

Antecedent Agreement

A pronoun should normally agree appropriately with its antecedent in **number and person**.

- Riya finished **her** work.
- The students finished **their** work.

Who, Whom, Whose

- **Who** → subject/person performing an action.
- **Whom** → object in formal usage.
- **Whose** → possession.

Who called you?

Whom did you meet?

Whose book is this?

💡 Exam Tip

Formal test: if the answer would be **he/she**, use **who**; if **him/her**, **whom** may be appropriate.

Part D — Adjectives

An **adjective** describes, identifies, or gives information about a noun/pronoun.

Degrees of Comparison

Degree	Example
Positive	tall
Comparative	taller
Superlative	tallest

Irregular forms:

- good → better → best
- bad → worse → worst
- little → less → least
- many/much → more → most

⚠ Warning

Avoid double comparison:

- ⊗ more better
- ⊗ most tallest
- ✓ better
- ✓ tallest

Order of Adjectives — Basic Rule

When several adjectives occur before a noun, a common order is:

Opinion → Size → Age → Shape → Colour → Origin → Material → Purpose + Noun

a beautiful small old round red Italian wooden table

This order is a guideline; natural English does not always require every category.

Part E — Verbs

A **verb** expresses an action, occurrence, or state.

Main Verb

She **writes** every day.

Auxiliary Verbs

- **be:** am, is, are, was, were, been, being
- **have:** have, has, had
- **do:** do, does, did

Modal Auxiliaries

Modal	Common meaning/use	Example
can	ability/possibility	She can swim.
could	past ability/polite possibility/request	Could you help me?
may	permission/possibility	May I come in?
might	weaker possibility	It might rain.
must	strong obligation/deduction	You must obey the rule.
should	advice/expectation	You should study.
will	future/willingness	I will help you.
would	polite request/hypothetical use	Would you help me?

🔑 Remember

After a modal, use the **base form (V1)**:

- can **swim**
- should **study**
- must **leave**

Not: ⊗ can swims / ⊗ should studied

Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

Transitive: takes a direct object in the construction.

She **opened the door**.

Intransitive: does not take a direct object in the construction.

The baby **slept**.

Verb Forms

Form	Example
V1	go
V2	went
V3	gone
V-ing	going
V1+s/es	goes

⚠️ Trap

After **did**, use V1: **Did he go?** not **Did he went?**

Part F — Non-Finite Verbs

Non-finite verb forms do not show tense/person agreement in the same way as finite verbs.

Infinitive

Usually **to + V1**:

I want **to learn**.

A bare infinitive is used after many modals:

You must **go**.

Gerund

The **V-ing** form functioning as a noun:

Reading is useful.

Participle

Participles can function in verb phrases or as modifiers.

- Present participle: **running** water
- Past participle: **broken** glass

⚠ Trap

Do not treat every **-ing** word as a gerund. Its function in the sentence matters.

Part G — Adverbs

An adverb can modify a verb, adjective, another adverb, or an entire clause.

Common Types

- Manner: slowly, carefully
- Time: now, yesterday, soon
- Place: here, there
- Frequency: always, often, never
- Degree: very, quite, too, almost

Examples:

- He runs **quickly**.
- She is **very** intelligent.
- He runs **quite** quickly.
- **Fortunately**, nobody was hurt.



⚠ Warning

Not every **-ly** word is an adverb. **Friendly** is commonly an adjective; **fast** can function as an adverb.

Part H — Prepositions

A preposition expresses a relationship of time, place, direction, cause, manner, or another kind.

Time

Preposition	Common use	Example
at	exact time	at 5 p.m.
on	day/date	on Monday
in	month/year/period	in July; in 2026
since	starting point	since Monday
for	duration	for two hours
by	deadline	by 6 p.m.
during	within a period/event	during the meeting

Place and Direction

- **in** → inside
- **on** → surface
- **at** → point/location
- **into** → movement to the inside
- **under** → lower than
- **above** → higher than
- **between** → relation between separately identified entities
- **among** → within a group

Commonly Confused Pairs

In / Into

The child is **in** the room.

The child went **into** the room.

By / With

The poem was written **by** Tagore.
He cut it **with** a knife.

Beside / Besides

- beside = next to
- besides = in addition to

⚡ Trick

Besides = in addition.

Beside = next to.

Part I — Conjunctions

A conjunction connects words, phrases, or clauses.

Coordinating Conjunctions

FANBOYS: For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.

Subordinating Conjunctions

because, although, if, when, unless, while, before, after, since, etc.

Correlative Conjunctions

- either...or
- neither...nor
- both...and
- not only...but also
- whether...or

💡 Exam Tip

Correlative conjunctions should normally connect grammatically parallel elements.

She likes **both singing and dancing**.

Part J — Articles and Determiners

Articles

A

Use **a** before a singular countable noun when the following sound is a consonant sound.

a book, a university, a European country

An

Use **an** before a singular countable noun when the following sound is a vowel sound.

an apple, an hour, an honest man, an MBA

⚡ Trick

A/An depends on sound, not spelling.

The

Use **the** when the noun is specific/identified and in several established expressions.

I saw a dog. **The dog** was barking.

The sun rises in the east.

Zero Article

No article is often used with plural or uncountable nouns when speaking generally:

Books are useful.

Water is essential for life.

Determiners

Determiners help identify or quantify nouns.

Common groups:

- Demonstratives: this, that, these, those
- Possessives: my, your, his, her, our, their
- Quantifiers: some, any, much, many, few, little, several, enough
- Distributives: each, every, either, neither
- Numbers: one, two, first, second

Few / A Few / Little / A Little

- **few** → almost none; countable plural
- **a few** → some; countable plural
- **little** → almost none; uncountable
- **a little** → some; uncountable

Few students attended.

A few students attended.

There is little water left.

There is a little water left.

⚠ Warning

Much/many: much → uncountable; many → countable plural.

Part K — Tenses

Tense/aspect expresses time and the way an event is viewed.

12-Tense Framework

Time	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Continuous
Present	V1 / V1+s/es	am/is/are + V-ing	has/have + V3	has/have been + V-ing
Past	V2	was/were + V-ing	had + V3	had been + V-ing
Future	will + V1	will be + V-ing	will have + V3	will have been + V-ing

Present Simple

Structure: Subject + V1/V1+s-es

Uses: habits, routines, facts, general truths, suitable schedules.

He **goes** to school every day.
The sun **rises** in the east.

Present Continuous

Structure: am/is/are + V-ing

She **is studying** now.

Used for actions happening around now, temporary situations, and suitable arrangements.

Present Perfect

Structure: has/have + V3

I **have finished** my work.

Used for past events with present relevance, experiences, and certain situations continuing to the present.

⚠ Trap

A finished past-time marker such as **yesterday** normally takes the past simple rather than present perfect.

⊗ I have seen him yesterday.

✓ I saw him yesterday.

Present Perfect Continuous

Structure: has/have been + V-ing

She **has been studying** for two hours.

Past Simple

Structure: V2

They **visited** Agra last year.

Past Continuous

Structure: was/were + V-ing

I **was reading** when he called.

Past Perfect

Structure: had + V3

The train **had left** before we reached the station.

Past Perfect Continuous

Structure: had been + V-ing

He **had been working** for three hours before the break.

Future Simple

Structure: will + V1

I **will call** you tomorrow.

Future Continuous

Structure: will be + V-ing

This time tomorrow, I **will be travelling**.

Future Perfect

Structure: will have + V3

By Friday, she **will have completed** the work.

Future Perfect Continuous

Structure: will have been + V-ing

By June, he **will have been teaching** for ten years.

Formula

Pattern memory:

- Continuous → **BE + V-ing**
- Perfect → **HAVE + V3**
- Perfect Continuous → **HAVE + BEEN + V-ing**
- After **will** → **V1**
- After **did** → **V1**

Part L — Subject-Verb Agreement

The verb agrees with the grammatical subject in person and number.

Core Rules

1. He **works** hard. / They **work** hard.
2. Intervening phrases do not normally change agreement: **The quality of these products is good.**
3. Each/every/everyone/everybody/someone/nobody normally take singular verbs.
4. With either...or / neither...nor, the verb commonly agrees with the nearer subject in standard exam constructions.
5. **along with, as well as, together with** do not normally make the main subject plural.
6. There **is** a book. / There **are** two books.
7. A collective noun can take singular or plural agreement depending on meaning and variety of English; follow the context and exam convention.

⚠ Trap

Nearest noun ≠ automatically the subject. Find the grammatical subject first.

Part M — Sentence Structure

Understanding sentence structure helps with error detection, transformation, and comprehension.

Phrase

A group of words functioning as a unit but normally without a finite verb.

in the morning

Clause

A group of words containing a subject-verb relationship.

when he arrived

Main Types of Sentences by Structure

Simple

One independent clause.

She works hard.

Compound

Two or more independent clauses joined appropriately.

She works hard, **and** she studies regularly.

Complex

One main clause + one or more subordinate clauses.

She works hard **because she wants to succeed**.

💡 Exam Tip

Independent clause can stand as a sentence. A **dependent/subordinate clause** cannot normally stand alone in the same way.

Part N — Active and Passive Voice

Active Voice

The subject performs the action.

The teacher **checked the answer**.

Passive Voice

The grammatical subject receives the action.

The answer **was checked by the teacher**.

Conversion Steps

1. Identify the active object.
2. Move it to passive subject position.
3. Choose the correct form of **be**.
4. Use V3.
5. Add the agent with **by** when useful.
6. Preserve tense and meaning.

Formula

Active: Subject + Verb + Object

Passive: Object + appropriate BE + V3 + (by + Subject)

Common Patterns

Active	Passive
writes	is/am/are written
wrote	was/were written
is writing	is/am/are being written
has written	has/have been written
had written	had been written
will write	will be written
can write	can be written

Imperative and Modal Examples

Open the door. → **Let the door be opened.**

You must obey the rule. → **The rule must be obeyed.**

⚠ Warning

A normal passive transformation requires a suitable transitive construction. Do not force a passive form for every intransitive verb.

Part O — Direct and Indirect Speech

Direct Speech

The speaker's exact words are quoted.

He said, "I am tired."

Indirect Speech

The meaning is reported without quoting the exact words.

He said that he was tired.

Conversion Checklist

1. Reporting verb
2. Pronouns
3. Tense/backshift where required
4. Time/place expressions
5. Sentence type
6. Connector

Common Time/Place Changes

Direct	Common indirect equivalent
now	then
today	that day
tomorrow	the next day
yesterday	the previous day
here	there
this	that
these	those

Statements

He said, "I am busy." → He said that he was busy.

Questions

He said, "Are you ready?" → He asked whether I was ready.

⚠ Trap

Indirect questions use **statement word order**:

- ⊗ He asked where was I going.
- ✓ He asked where I was going.

Commands / Requests / Advice

The teacher said to me, "Open the book."

The teacher told me to open the book.

The reporting verb should reflect the meaning: **told, ordered, requested, advised, warned**, etc.

Exclamatory Sentences

The reporting verb may change according to the emotion expressed, such as **exclaimed with joy/sorrow/surprise**.

Part P — Common Error Detection

Incorrect	Correct	Rule
He do his work.	He does his work.	3rd-person singular
Did he went?	Did he go?	did + V1
She is more better.	She is better.	no double comparison
He is an university student.	He is a university student.	sound-based article
I have seen him yesterday.	I saw him yesterday.	finished past time
Everyone are ready.	Everyone is ready.	singular indefinite pronoun
She is good in English.	She is good at English.	standard collocation
He discussed about the issue.	He discussed the issue.	discuss + object

💡 Exam Tip

For error detection, check:

Subject-Verb → Tense → Article/Determiner → Preposition → Pronoun → Modifier → Word usage

Part Q — Confusing Word Pairs

These are common exam-error areas.

Word	Meaning/Use	Example
advice	noun	He gave me advice.
advise	verb	I advise you to study.
affect	usually verb	Noise can affect health.
effect	usually noun	The effect was clear.
accept	receive/agree	He accepted the offer.
except	excluding	Everyone came except Ravi.
principal	head/main	school principal
principle	rule/belief	moral principle
stationery	writing materials	buy stationery
stationary	not moving	The car remained stationary.

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Part R — Hindi Help: Quick Grammar Map

English	Short Hindi Help
Noun	नाम बताने वाला word
Pronoun	Noun के स्थान/संदर्भ में आने वाला word
Adjective	Noun/Pronoun की विशेषता बताता है
Verb	Action/State बताता है
Adverb	Verb/Adjective/Adverb को modify करता है
Preposition	संबंध/स्थान/समय आदि बताता है
Conjunction	words/clauses को जोड़ता है
Article	noun के reference को mark करता है
Determiner	noun को identify/quantify करता है
Tense	time/aspect की grammatical expression
Voice	subject/object की grammatical role बताता है
Narration	कही गई बात को report करने का तरीका

Part S — Master Revision Sheet

Remember

- Part of Speech → identify by **function and context**.
- Countable and uncountable nouns behave differently.
- Pronouns need a clear, appropriate antecedent.
- Comparative/superlative forms should not be doubled.
- Modal → **V1**.
- did → **V1**.
- Continuous → **BE + V-ing**.
- Perfect → **HAVE + V3**.
- A/An → **sound**, not spelling.
- Since → starting point; for → duration.
- Subject controls subject-verb agreement.
- Passive normally requires a suitable transitive construction.
- Indirect questions use statement word order.
- Few/a few → countable plural; little/a little → uncountable.

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Part T — Practice Set

Practice

Section A — Grammar MCQs

1. Which word is an abstract noun?

- A. table
- B. honesty
- C. teacher
- D. Delhi

2. He is ___ honest man.

- A. a B. an C. the D. no article

3. She did not ___ to school.

- A. went B. goes C. go D. going

4. Everyone ___ ready.

- A. are B. were C. is D. have

5. She has lived here ___ 2020.

- A. for B. since C. during D. by

6. Which is correct?

- A. He can swims.
- B. He can swim.
- C. He can swimming.
- D. He can swam.

7. Identify the adverb: The child answered quickly.

- A. child B. answered C. quickly D. the

8. Which is correct?

- A. Did she went there?
- B. Did she goes there?
- C. Did she go there?
- D. Did she going there?

9. The quality of these products ___ good.

- A. are B. were C. is D. have

10. He studies at ___ university.

A. an B. a C. the D. no article

11. By Friday, she ___ the work.

A. completes
B. completed
C. will have completed
D. has completing

12. Choose the correct indirect question.

A. He asked where was I going.
B. He asked where I was going.
C. He asked where am I going.
D. He asked where I going was.

13. Which is correct?

A. She is more better than me.
B. She is better than me.
C. She is most better than me.
D. She is very better than me.

14. He cut the paper ___ a knife.

A. by B. with C. from D. at

15. The teacher praised the student. Choose the passive form.

A. The student praised the teacher.
B. The student was praised by the teacher.
C. The student is praised by the teacher.
D. The student had praised the teacher.

16. Which sentence uses a non-finite form as a noun?

A. He is running.
B. Running is good exercise.
C. He runs daily.
D. He ran yesterday.

17. Choose the correct option: There are ___ students in the room.

A. much B. little C. many D. a little

18. Choose the correct word: The school ___ addressed the assembly.

A. principal B. principle C. principally D. principled

19. Choose the correct sentence.

A. He discussed about the problem.
B. He discussed the problem.
C. He discussed on the problem.
D. He discussed for the problem.

20. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He asked where was she going.
- B. He asked where she was going.
- C. He asked where is she going.
- D. He asked where going she was.



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Answer Key

Q	Ans	Key Point
1	B	Abstract noun
2	B	vowel sound in honest
3	C	did + V1
4	C	everyone → singular verb
5	B	since + starting point
6	B	modal + V1
7	C	adverb of manner
8	C	did + V1
9	C	subject = quality
10	B	university begins with consonant sound
11	C	future perfect
12	B	indirect-question word order
13	B	no double comparison
14	B	instrument → with
15	B	past simple passive
16	B	gerund functioning as noun
17	C	many + countable plural noun
18	A	principal = school head
19	B	discuss + object
20	B	statement word order

💡 Exam Tip

Practice Method: After every wrong answer, return to the relevant rule and solve one fresh example. Detailed notes are meant for understanding, not only memorisation.

General English — Vocabulary

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Scope: Synonyms • Antonyms • One Word Substitution • Commonly Used Words • Idioms/Phrases • Spelling

Method: Meaning → Usage → Context → Practice

::: note **Hindi Help:** English is the primary language. Hindi is used only for difficult meanings, distinctions, or memory support. :::

1. What is Vocabulary?

Vocabulary is the collection of words a learner understands and uses. In competitive exams, vocabulary questions test **meaning, word relationships, correct usage, spelling, and context**.

For PET, a useful vocabulary record contains:

1. Word
2. Meaning
3. Part of speech
4. Synonym
5. Antonym, where useful
6. Example sentence
7. Confusing word, where applicable
8. Correct spelling

💡 Exam Tip

Do not memorise a word only as a Hindi translation. Learn it with a short English sentence so you can recognise it in a question or passage.

2. Synonyms

A **synonym** is a word with the same or a very similar meaning in a particular context. Exact interchangeability is not guaranteed in every sentence.



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2.1 High-Frequency Synonyms — A-C

Word	Synonym	Short Meaning
Abandon	Leave	give up/leave
Abolish	End	officially end
Abrupt	Sudden	unexpected
Accurate	Exact	correct
Adequate	Sufficient	enough
Adversity	Hardship	difficult condition
Alleviate	Relieve	make less severe
Ambiguous	Unclear	more than one possible meaning
Ancient	Old	belonging to the distant past
Apparent	Obvious	easy to notice
Arrogant	Haughty	overly proud
Authentic	Genuine	real
Benevolent	Kind	well-meaning
Brief	Short	not long
Brutal	Cruel	harsh/violent
Cautious	Careful	avoiding risk
Cease	Stop	come to an end
Commence	Begin	start
Compel	Force	make someone do something
Conceal	Hide	keep from view
Confess	Admit	acknowledge wrongdoing/truth
Conspicuous	Noticeable	easy to see

Word	Synonym	Short Meaning
Courageous	Brave	showing courage

2.2 High-Frequency Synonyms — D-H

Word	Synonym	Short Meaning
Diligent	Hardworking	careful and industrious
Diminish	Reduce	become/make smaller
Diverse	Varied	different
Eager	Keen	enthusiastic
Eliminate	Remove	get rid of
Essential	Necessary	absolutely needed
Evident	Clear	easy to see/understand
Fragile	Delicate	easily broken
Frequent	Often	occurring repeatedly
Genuine	Authentic	real
Generous	Liberal	willing to give
Hostile	Unfriendly	antagonistic
Humble	Modest	not boastful

2.3 High-Frequency Synonyms — I-P

Word	Synonym	Short Meaning
Inevitable	Unavoidable	certain to happen
Infer	Deduce	conclude from evidence
Intelligent	Clever	mentally capable
Lament	Mourn	express sorrow
Mandatory	Compulsory	required
Meticulous	Careful	very precise/careful
Obsolete	Outdated	no longer in use
Obvious	Evident	easy to understand
Persuade	Convince	cause someone to agree
Precise	Exact	accurate
Prohibit	Forbid	officially prevent

2.4 High-Frequency Synonyms — R-Z

Word	Synonym	Short Meaning
Rapid	Swift	very fast
Rare	Uncommon	not common
Reluctant	Unwilling	not ready/willing
Reliable	Dependable	can be trusted
Reveal	Disclose	make known
Significant	Important	meaningful
Sufficient	Enough	adequate
Temporary	Short-term	not permanent
Vacant	Empty	unoccupied
Vital	Essential	extremely important
Weary	Tired	exhausted

⚠ Warning

Synonyms are often **context-dependent**. Two words may be similar in one sentence but not interchangeable in every situation.

3. Antonyms

An **antonym** expresses an opposite or contrasting meaning.

3.1 High-Frequency Antonym Pairs

Word	Antonym
Abundant	Scarce
Accept	Reject
Ancient	Modern
Artificial	Natural
Arrival	Departure
Attractive	Repulsive
Bold	Timid
Broad	Narrow
Cautious	Careless
Complex	Simple
Create	Destroy
Expand	Contract
External	Internal
Failure	Success
Generous	Stingy
Guilty	Innocent
Hope	Despair
Humble	Arrogant
Increase	Decrease
Maximum	Minimum
Permanent	Temporary
Public	Private

Word	Antonym
Rare	Common
Victory	Defeat
Visible	Invisible



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3.2 More Important Pairs

Word	Antonym
Active	Passive
Advantage	Disadvantage
Capable	Incapable
Cheap	Expensive
Courage	Cowardice
Domestic	Foreign
Early	Late
Flexible	Rigid
Friend	Enemy
Include	Exclude
Liberty	Slavery
Major	Minor
Optimist	Pessimist
Partial	Complete
Polite	Rude
Prosperity	Poverty
Strength	Weakness
Transparent	Opaque

⚡ Trick

For an antonym, first identify the **exact meaning** of the given word. Then choose the option that directly reverses or contrasts that meaning.

4. One Word Substitution

One-word substitution replaces a phrase or description with one suitable English word.



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4.1 Persons

Description	One Word
One who cannot read or write	Illiterate
One who loves mankind	Philanthropist
One who hates mankind	Misanthrope
One who loves books	Bibliophile
One who knows many languages	Polyglot
One who speaks two languages	Bilingual
One who looks at the bright side	Optimist
One who expects the worst	Pessimist
One who cannot be corrected	Incorrigible
One who travels from place to place	Itinerant
One who eats too much	Glutton
One who talks too much	Garrulous
One who is new to an activity	Novice
One who knows everything	Omniscient
One who is all-powerful	Omnipotent
One who is present everywhere	Omnipresent
One who hates women	Misogynist
One who studies mankind	Anthropologist
One who studies plants	Botanist
One who studies animals	Zoologist
One who studies stars/space	Astronomer
One who writes poems	Poet

Description	One Word
One who writes plays	Dramatist
One who writes dictionaries	Lexicographer

4.2 Places and Institutions

Description	One Word
Place where books are kept	Library
Place where animals are kept	Zoo
Place where aircraft are kept	Hangar
Place where coins are made	Mint
Place where weapons are stored	Arsenal
Place where dead bodies are examined/kept	Morgue
Place where soldiers live	Barracks
Place where monks live	Monastery
Place where nuns live	Convent
Place where prisoners are kept	Prison
Place where experiments are conducted	Laboratory
Place where birds are kept	Aviary
Place where bees are kept	Apiary
Place where ships are repaired/kept	Dockyard

4.3 Concepts and Conditions

Description	One Word
That which cannot be avoided	Inevitable
That which cannot be seen	Invisible
That which cannot be heard	Inaudible
That which cannot be conquered	Invincible
That which cannot be cured	Incurable
That which cannot be believed	Incredible
That which cannot be read	Illegible
That which cannot be explained	Inexplicable
That which can be used only once	Disposable
A speech made without preparation	Extempore
Life history written by oneself	Autobiography
Life history written by another	Biography
Government by the people	Democracy
Government by one person	Autocracy
Government by a small group	Oligarchy

Remember

Autobiography = life story written by oneself.

Biography = life story written by another person.

5. Commonly Used Words

Word	Meaning	Example
Adequate	enough	The resources are adequate.
Cautious	careful	Be cautious while driving.
Concise	brief but complete	Give a concise answer.
Diligent	hardworking	She is a diligent student.
Elaborate	detailed	He gave an elaborate explanation.
Genuine	real	This is a genuine document.
Hostile	unfriendly	The crowd became hostile.
Inevitable	unavoidable	Change is inevitable.
Mandatory	required	Attendance is mandatory.
Obsolete	outdated	The machine is obsolete.
Precise	exact	Give a precise answer.
Reluctant	unwilling	He was reluctant to speak.
Significant	important	It was a significant decision.
Sufficient	enough	The evidence is sufficient.
Transparent	clear/open	The process should be transparent.
Vulnerable	easily harmed	Some groups are vulnerable.
Ambiguous	unclear	The statement is ambiguous.
Adverse	unfavourable/harmful	The medicine caused adverse effects.
Compulsory	mandatory	Attendance is compulsory.
Meticulous	very careful	She is meticulous in her work.

6. Idioms and Phrases

An **idiom** is a fixed expression whose overall meaning cannot always be understood by translating each word literally.

6.1 Important Idioms — A-M

Idiom	Meaning	Example
A blessing in disguise	apparently bad but ultimately beneficial	The delay was a blessing in disguise.
A piece of cake	very easy	The task was a piece of cake.
At the eleventh hour	at the last moment	He applied at the eleventh hour.
Break the ice	start a friendly interaction	The teacher told a joke to break the ice.
Burn the midnight oil	work/study late at night	She burned the midnight oil before the exam.
Call it a day	stop work for the day	Let us call it a day.
Hit the nail on the head	say exactly the right thing	You hit the nail on the head.
In hot water	in trouble	He is in hot water.
Once in a blue moon	very rarely	He visits us once in a blue moon.
Spill the beans	reveal a secret	She spilled the beans.
Under the weather	feeling unwell	I am under the weather today.

6.2 Important Idioms — N-Z

Idiom	Meaning	Example
On cloud nine	extremely happy	She was on cloud nine.
See eye to eye	agree completely	We do not always see eye to eye.
Take to task	scold/criticise	The manager took him to task.
The last straw	final problem in a series	The delay was the last straw.
Through thick and thin	in good and bad times	They supported each other through thick and thin.
Turn a deaf ear	refuse to listen	He turned a deaf ear to the warning.
A storm in a teacup	fuss about a small matter	It was a storm in a teacup.
Cost an arm and a leg	be very expensive	The car cost an arm and a leg.
Keep an eye on	watch carefully	Keep an eye on the child.
Make both ends meet	manage financially	It is difficult to make both ends meet.
Put off	postpone	They put off the meeting.
Look down upon	regard as inferior	Never look down upon others.
In the long run	eventually/over time	It will help in the long run.
By leaps and bounds	very rapidly	The company is growing by leaps and bounds.

⚠ Warning

Do not translate idioms word-for-word. Learn **idiom** → **meaning** → **example** as one unit.

Hindi Help: Idiom का meaning अक्सर literal words से अलग होता है।

7. Spelling

Spelling questions may ask you to identify the correctly spelled word or the incorrect spelling.

7.1 High-Frequency Spellings

Correct	Common Wrong Form
Accommodation	Accomodation
Beginning	Begining
Beautiful	Beautifull
Calendar	Calender
Committee	Commitee
Definitely	Definately
Environment	Enviroment
Government	Goverment
Independent	Independant
Necessary	Necesary
Occurrence	Occurence
Privilege	Priviledge
Pronunciation	Pronounciation
Receive	Recieve
Separate	Seperate
Successful	Succesful
Tomorrow	Tommorow
Maintenance	Maintainance
Questionnaire	Questionaire
Embarrass	Embarass
Existence	Existance
Knowledge	Knowlege

Correct	Common Wrong Form
Liaison	Liason
Millennium	Millenium
Restaurant	Restuarant
Rhythm	Rythm

7.2 Spelling Clues

Pay special attention to:

- double consonants
- vowel order
- silent letters
- common suffixes
- repeated letters

⚡ Trick

When options look similar, compare them letter-by-letter. Do not rely only on how the word sounds.

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8. Homophones and Confusing Words

Word 1	Word 2	Difference
accept	except	receive/agree vs excluding
advice	advise	noun vs verb
affect	effect	usually verb vs usually noun
principal	principle	head/main vs rule/belief
stationery	stationary	writing materials vs not moving
complement	compliment	completes vs praise
loose	lose	not tight vs fail to keep
later	latter	afterwards vs second of two
beside	besides	next to vs in addition
personal	personnel	individual/private vs staff
adapt	adopt	adjust vs take up/accept
assure	ensure	tell confidently vs make certain
allusion	illusion	indirect reference vs false appearance
moral	morale	principle of right/wrong vs confidence/spirit
practice	practise	noun vs verb in British usage
conscience	conscious	moral sense vs aware
desert	dessert	dry region/abandon vs sweet course

Example

Advice / Advise

- He gave me useful **advice**. → noun
- I **advise** you to study. → verb

Principal / Principle

- The school **principal** addressed the students.
- Honesty is an important **principle**.

9. Word Formation

Prefixes and suffixes can help you infer meaning and grammatical category.

9.1 Common Prefixes

Prefix	General idea	Example
un-	not/reversal	unhappy
dis-	opposite/absence	dishonest
re-	again	rewrite
mis-	wrongly	misunderstand
pre-	before	preview
post-	after	postgraduate
anti-	against	antiwar
inter-	between	international
intra-	within	intrastate
sub-	under/below	submarine
super-	above/beyond	supernatural
trans-	across	transport

9.2 Common Suffixes

Suffix	Common role	Example
-ness	noun	kindness
-ment	noun	development
-tion/-sion	noun	education, decision
-ity	noun	ability
-er/-or	person/agent	teacher, actor
-ful	adjective	useful
-less	adjective	careless
-able/-ible	adjective	readable, visible
-ly	commonly adverb	quickly

Exam Tip

Prefixes and suffixes are clues, not guaranteed formulas. Confirm the meaning from context.

10. Vocabulary in Context

When an unfamiliar word appears in a sentence or passage, use context clues.

Definition Clue

The sentence directly explains the word.

Contrast Clue

Words such as **but**, **however**, **unlike**, **although** may signal contrast.

Example Clue

Examples around the word may reveal its meaning.

Restatement Clue

A later phrase may express the same idea in simpler language.

∴ strategy **Context-solving method:**

1. Read the whole sentence.
2. Identify the likely part of speech.
3. Read before and after the word.
4. Look for definition, contrast, example, or restatement.
5. Substitute each option mentally.
6. Select the option that fits the complete context. ∴

11. Vocabulary by Part of Speech

Learning related forms helps with sentence-based questions.

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
success	succeed	successful	successfully
beauty	beautify	beautiful	beautifully
decision	decide	decisive	decisively
difference	differ	different	differently
importance	—	important	importantly
care	care	careful/careless	carefully/carelessly
confidence	—	confident	confidently
patience	—	patient	patiently

::: note Not every word has a common form in all four columns. Learn natural usage rather than forcing a word into every category. :::

12. High-Frequency Vocabulary Bank

A-E

- Abandon — leave/give up
- Abolish — officially end
- Abundant — plentiful
- Accurate — exact/correct
- Adequate — sufficient
- Adverse — harmful/unfavourable
- Ambiguous — unclear
- Apparent — obvious
- Authentic — genuine
- Benevolent — kind
- Cautious — careful
- Cease — stop
- Compel — force
- Conceal — hide
- Concise — brief but complete
- Diligent — hardworking
- Diminish — reduce
- Diverse — varied
- Eager — keen
- Eliminate — remove
- Essential — necessary

F-P

- Fragile — easily broken
- Frequent — occurring often
- Genuine — real

- Hostile — unfriendly
- Humble — modest
- Inevitable — unavoidable
- Infer — deduce
- Mandatory — compulsory
- Meticulous — very careful
- Obsolete — outdated
- Obvious — clear
- Persuade — convince
- Precise — exact
- Prohibit — forbid

R-Z

- Rapid — swift
- Rare — uncommon
- Reluctant — unwilling
- Reliable — dependable
- Reveal — disclose
- Significant — important
- Sufficient — enough
- Temporary — short-term
- Vacant — empty
- Vital — essential
- Weary — tired



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13. Exam Vocabulary Strategy

Before the Exam

- Learn 15-20 useful words regularly.
- Revise old words before adding new ones.
- Maintain synonym and antonym pairs.
- Learn one sentence for difficult words.

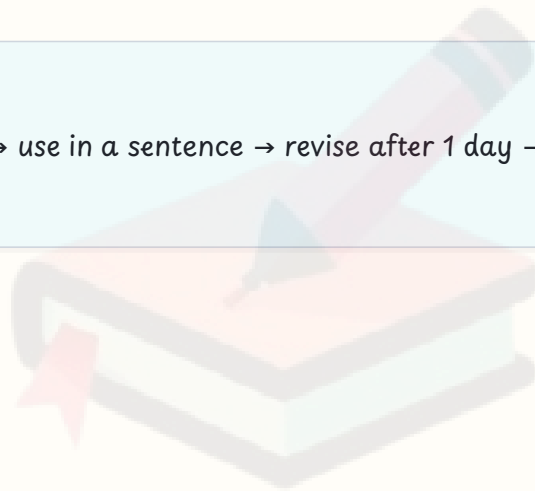
- Maintain a spelling-error list.
- Group confusing words together.

During the Exam

1. Read the complete question.
2. Identify whether it asks synonym, antonym, usage, spelling, or substitution.
3. Eliminate clearly unrelated options.
4. Use context whenever available.
5. Do not spend excessive time on one unfamiliar word.

Exam Tip

Best revision cycle: Learn → use in a sentence → revise after 1 day → revise after 1 week → test yourself.



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14. Practice Set — Vocabulary

Practice

1. Choose the synonym of **Abandon**.
A. Keep B. Leave C. Build D. Protect
2. Choose the antonym of **Ancient**.
A. Old B. Historic C. Modern D. Former
3. One who loves books is called a:
A. Bibliophile B. Misanthrope C. Polyglot D. Optimist
4. One who knows many languages is a:
A. Novice B. Polyglot C. Illiterate D. Glutton
5. One who cannot read or write is:
A. Literate B. Illiterate C. Omniscient D. Itinerant
6. "At the eleventh hour" means:
A. Very early B. At the last moment C. Every hour D. For eleven hours
7. "Break the ice" means:
A. Create a problem B. Start a friendly interaction C. End a meeting D. Break something
8. Choose the correct spelling.
A. Seperate B. Separate C. Seprate D. Separete
9. Choose the correct spelling.
A. Accomodation B. Accommodation C. Acommodation D. Accommadation
10. He gave me useful _____.
A. advices B. advice C. advise D. advises
11. Everyone came ___ Ravi.
A. accept B. advice C. except D. affect
12. Choose the antonym of **Expand**.
A. Increase B. Extend C. Contract D. Enlarge
13. Choose the synonym of **Reluctant**.
A. Unwilling B. Eager C. Certain D. Generous
14. The school ___ addressed the assembly.
A. principle B. principal C. principally D. principled
15. The car remained _____.
A. stationery B. stationary C. stationarity D. stationed

16. "Under the weather" means:

A. Outdoors B. Feeling unwell C. Travelling D. Feeling excited

17. One who loves mankind is a:

A. Misanthrope B. Philanthropist C. Misogynist D. Pessimist

18. One who cannot be conquered is:

A. Invisible B. Incurable C. Invincible D. Inaudible

19. Choose the antonym of **Permanent**.

A. Stable B. Fixed C. Temporary D. Lasting

20. Choose the synonym of **Precise**.

A. Exact B. Rough C. Vague D. Careless

21. "Spill the beans" means:

A. Waste food B. Reveal a secret C. Make a mistake D. Work hard

22. Noise can ___ concentration.

A. effect B. affect C. except D. accept

23. The ___ of the decision was significant.

A. affect B. effect C. advice D. advise

24. Choose the antonym of **Generous**.

A. Kind B. Stingy C. Helpful D. Noble

25. A life history written by oneself is called:

A. Biography B. Autobiography C. Bibliography D. Geography

26. A government by the people is:

A. Autocracy B. Oligarchy C. Democracy D. Monarchy

27. Choose the correct spelling.

A. Definately B. Definitly C. Definitely D. Definetely

28. Choose the synonym of **Obsolete**.

A. Modern B. Outdated C. Current D. New

29. Honesty is an important ___.

A. principal B. principle C. principally D. principalise

30. "Make both ends meet" means:

A. Join two objects B. Manage financially C. Finish early D. Travel widely

31. Choose the antonym of **Visible**.

A. Clear B. Obvious C. Invisible D. Apparent

32. Choose the synonym of **Diligent**.

A. Lazy B. Hardworking C. Careless D. Weak

- 33.** A person new to a profession or activity is a:
A. Veteran B. Novice C. Expert D. Master
- 34.** "Hit the nail on the head" means:
A. Work with tools B. Say exactly the right thing C. Make a mistake D. Avoid a problem
- 35.** Choose the correct spelling.
A. Pronounciation B. Pronunciation C. Pronuncation D. Pronounciaton
- 36.** Please ___ that the door is locked.
A. assure B. ensure C. insure D. assurance
- 37.** The tie ___ the shirt.
A. compliments B. complements C. complimants D. complementing
- 38.** Choose the antonym of **Hostile**.
A. Friendly B. Angry C. Violent D. Unfriendly
- 39.** "Once in a blue moon" means:
A. Very often B. Very rarely C. Every month D. At night
- 40.** Choose the synonym of **Inevitable**.
A. Avoidable B. Unavoidable C. Unlikely D. Optional
- 41.** Choose the correct spelling.
A. Enviroment B. Envirnoment C. Environment D. Environmant
- 42.** One who writes dictionaries is a:
A. Biographer B. Lexicographer C. Calligrapher D. Photographer
- 43.** Choose the antonym of **Maximum**.
A. Minimum B. Major C. Large D. Highest
- 44.** "Put off" means:
A. Wear B. Postpone C. Remove permanently D. Encourage
- 45.** The two sides reached a _____.
A. consensus B. conscious C. conscience D. consenting
- 46.** Choose the synonym of **Reveal**.
A. Conceal B. Disclose C. Hide D. Cover
- 47.** Choose the antonym of **Scarce**.
A. Rare B. Abundant C. Limited D. Insufficient
- 48.** Choose the correct spelling.
A. Occurence B. Occurrence C. Ocurrence D. Occurance
- 49.** "In the long run" means:
A. Immediately B. Eventually/over a long period C. Randomly D. Never

50. He gave me a sincere ____.

A. compliment B. complement C. complementary D. complimenting



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15. Answer Key

Q	Ans	Key Point
1	B	abandon = leave
2	C	ancient ↔ modern
3	A	bibliophile
4	B	polyglot
5	B	illiterate
6	B	last moment
7	B	start friendly interaction
8	B	separate
9	B	accommodation
10	B	advice = noun
11	C	except = excluding
12	C	expand ↔ contract
13	A	reluctant = unwilling
14	B	principal = school head
15	B	stationary = not moving
16	B	feeling unwell
17	B	philanthropist
18	C	invincible
19	C	permanent ↔ temporary
20	A	precise = exact
21	B	reveal a secret

Q	Ans	Key Point
22	B	affect = usually verb
23	B	effect = usually noun
24	B	generous ↔ stingy
25	B	autobiography
26	C	democracy
27	C	definitely
28	B	obsolete = outdated
29	B	principle = rule/belief
30	B	manage financially
31	C	visible ↔ invisible
32	B	diligent = hardworking
33	B	novice
34	B	exactly right
35	B	pronunciation
36	B	ensure = make certain
37	B	complement = completes/goes well with
38	A	hostile ↔ friendly
39	B	very rarely
40	B	inevitable = unavoidable
41	C	environment
42	B	lexicographer
43	A	maximum ↔ minimum
44	B	put off = postpone
45	A	consensus = general agreement

Q	Ans	Key Point
46	B	reveal = disclose
47	B	scarce ↔ abundant
48	B	occurrence
49	B	eventually/over time
50	A	compliment = praise

🔑 Remember

PET Vocabulary Formula:

Word → Meaning → Part of Speech → Synonym/Antonym → Usage → Confusing Pair → Revision → Practice

This is the standard to follow for the remaining PET English notes.

General English — Sentence Ability

PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

Focus: Sentence Correction → Sentence Improvement → Fill in the Blanks → Error Detection → Sentence Arrangement

Hindi Help: Only for difficult grammar logic or confusing exam patterns.

1. What is Sentence Ability?

Sentence ability means understanding whether a sentence is **grammatically correct, logically complete, properly ordered, and appropriate in context**.

For PET, sentence ability is built from grammar, vocabulary, collocation, context, and logical sequencing.

💡 Exam Tip

Exam Tip: Never change a sentence simply because it sounds unusual. Identify the exact grammar, usage, or logic rule first.

2. Sentence Structure Basics

A basic sentence can be represented as:

Subject + Verb + Object / Complement

Ravi reads books.

- **Subject:** the person/thing about which the sentence is made.
- **Verb:** action, occurrence, or state.
- **Object:** receives the action.
- **Complement:** completes the meaning of the subject/object.

2.1 Phrase vs Clause

Phrase: a group of words functioning as a unit, normally without a finite verb.

in the morning

Clause: a group of words containing a subject-verb relationship.

when he arrived

2.2 Sentence Types by Structure

Simple Sentence

One independent clause.

She works hard.

Compound Sentence

Two or more independent clauses joined appropriately.

She works hard, and she studies regularly.

Complex Sentence

One independent clause and one or more subordinate clauses.

She studies hard because she wants to succeed.

Core Concept

Sentence structure is the foundation of **correction, improvement, error detection, and arrangement** questions.

3. Sentence Correction

Sentence correction asks you to identify an incorrect form and replace it with the grammatically or contextually correct form.

3.1 Correction Checklist

Check in this order:

1. Subject-Verb Agreement
2. Tense and verb form
3. Pronoun
4. Article / Determiner
5. Preposition
6. Adjective / Adverb
7. Conjunction
8. Word order
9. Parallel structure
10. Meaning and logical fit

11. Collocation / idiomatic usage

∴ strategy **Locate** → **Identify the rule** → **Correct** → **Re-read the complete sentence.**

Change only what is necessary. ∴

4. Subject-Verb Errors

A singular subject generally takes a singular verb in the present simple; a plural subject generally takes a plural verb.

⊗ He **go** to school.

✓ He **goes** to school.

⊗ The students **is** ready.

✓ The students **are** ready.

Intervening Phrases

⊗ The quality of these products **are** good.

✓ The quality of these products **is** good.

The subject is **quality**, not products.

⚠ Trap

Do not select the verb according to the nearest noun. Find the grammatical subject first.

5. Tense and Verb-Form Errors

After Do / Does / Did

Use V1.

⊗ Did he **went** there?

✓ Did he **go** there?

⊗ She does not **likes** tea.

✓ She does not **like** tea.

After Modals

Use V1.

- ⊗ He can **swims**.
- ✓ He can **swim**.

Perfect Forms

Use **have/has/had + V3**.

- ⊗ She has **went** home.
- ✓ She has **gone** home.

🔑 Remember

did + V1

modal + V1

have/has/had + V3

6. Pronoun Errors

A pronoun should clearly and appropriately refer to its antecedent.

- ⊗ Riya told Priya that **she** had won.
This may be ambiguous without context.

Pronoun Case

After a preposition, use the appropriate object form in formal standard usage:

- ⊗ Between you and **I**
- ✓ Between you and **me**

💡 Exam Tip

Always identify the antecedent before selecting a pronoun.

7. Article and Determiner Errors

A / An

Choose according to sound.

- ☐ an university
- ☒ a university
- ☐ a hour
- ☒ an hour

Much / Many

- **many** + countable plural noun
 - **much** + uncountable noun
- ☐ much students
- ☒ many students

Few / A Few / Little / A Little

- few → almost none; countable plural
- a few → some; countable plural
- little → almost none; uncountable
- a little → some; uncountable

⚠ Trap

The article can change the meaning: **few** and **a few** are not equivalent.

8. Preposition Errors

Common combinations:

- good **at** English

- interested **in** music
- depend **on** someone
- consist **of** parts
- listen **to** music
- responsible **for** the work
- afraid **of** dogs
- different **from** another

⊗ He discussed **about** the issue.

✓ He discussed the issue.

⚠ Warning

Learn prepositions with the word they normally accompany. Direct translation from Hindi often creates errors.

9. Adjective and Adverb Errors

Adjective: modifies a noun/pronoun.

She is a **careful** driver.

Adverb: modifies a verb, adjective, adverb, or clause.

She drives **carefully**.

After linking verbs such as **be, seem, look, feel, become**, an adjective is often used to describe the subject.

She looks **beautiful**.

⚠ Trap

Do not automatically add **-ly** to make an adverb. Word function and meaning matter.

10. Comparison Errors

Comparative

Ravi is **taller than** Mohan.

Superlative

Ravi is **the tallest** boy in the class.

Avoid double comparison:

- ⊗ more better
- ⊗ most tallest
- ✓ better
- ✓ tallest

Common irregular forms:

- good → better → best
- bad → worse → worst
- little → less → least
- many/much → more → most

11. Conjunction Errors

Common correlative pairs:

- either...or
- neither...nor
- both...and
- not only...but also
- whether...or

She is **not only intelligent but also hardworking**.

⚠ Warning

Maintain parallel grammatical structures after paired conjunctions.

12. Parallelism

Parallelism means using the same grammatical form for items in a series or comparison.

⊗ She likes **reading, to write, and dancing**.

✓ She likes **reading, writing, and dancing**.

Other examples:

⊗ He wanted to **study, working, and to travel**.

✓ He wanted to **study, work, and travel**.

Core Concept

When several items are joined by **and/or**, check whether they perform the same grammatical role.

13. Modifiers and Word Order

A modifier should be positioned so that its intended meaning is clear.

Basic Word Order

Subject → Verb → Object

The student solved the problem.

Misplaced Modifier

She almost finished all the work.

The position of **almost** affects what is being limited.

Exam Tip

English generally depends more strongly on word order than Hindi. Avoid direct word-for-word translation.

14. Sentence Improvement

Sentence improvement questions present a sentence with an underlined or highlighted part. You must select the option that gives the **best grammatical and contextual form**.

14.1 Improvement Strategy

1. Read the complete sentence.
2. Identify the faulty portion.
3. Determine the rule involved.
4. Check whether the original may already be correct.
5. Compare the alternatives.
6. Choose the most natural and precise form.

::: strategy **Do not improve only grammar**. Check grammar + meaning + tense + collocation + logical consistency. :::

14.2 Common Improvement Areas

- subject-verb agreement
- tense
- articles
- prepositions
- pronouns
- comparison
- parallelism
- word choice
- collocation
- redundancy

Examples

1. He is senior **than** me.
→ He is senior **to** me.
2. She returned **back** home.
→ She returned home.
3. He discussed **about** the issue.
→ He discussed the issue.
4. She is **more better** than her sister.
→ She is better than her sister.

⚠ Warning

Some improvement questions contain an option such as **"No improvement"**. Do not change a correct sentence unnecessarily.

15. Redundancy

Redundancy occurs when unnecessary words repeat the same meaning.

Common examples:

- return back → return
- repeat again → repeat
- discuss about → discuss
- enter into the room → enter the room (when "enter" means go into)
- revert back → revert

⚠ Trap

Not every repeated-looking phrase is automatically wrong; judge the actual construction and meaning.

16. Fill in the Blanks

Fill-in-the-blank questions can test grammar, vocabulary, collocation, and context.

Step-by-Step Method

1. Read the entire sentence.
2. Predict the required part of speech.
3. Check grammar.
4. Check meaning.
5. Check collocation.
6. Insert the best option.
7. Re-read the full sentence.

Grammar Clues

He is ___ honest man. → **an**

She is good ___ English. → **at**

Everyone ___ ready. → **is**

She has ___ the work. → **completed**

Context Clue

The instructions were very ___, so everyone understood them.

The answer should express **clarity**, not simply fit grammatically.

17. Cloze-Style Context Fillers

A cloze passage contains several blanks. Each blank must be solved using the **local grammar and the overall meaning of the passage**.

Cloze Strategy

1. Read the complete passage once.
2. Identify the topic and tone.
3. Predict the missing word.
4. Check grammar around the blank.
5. Check the meaning of the whole sentence.
6. Re-read the passage after filling all blanks.

::: strategy Do not solve every cloze blank independently. Later sentences can provide clues for earlier blanks. :::

18. Collocations

A collocation is a combination of words that commonly occur together.

Examples:

- **make** a decision
- **do** homework
- **take** a break
- **pay** attention
- **catch** a bus
- **heavy** rain
- **strong** tea
- **deep** sleep
- **commit** a crime
- **keep** a promise

⚠ Warning

A grammatically possible word is not always the natural word. Collocation can determine the correct answer.

19. Error Detection

In error-detection questions, a sentence may be divided into parts.

He / do / his work / regularly.

Error → **do**

Correction → **does**

Error Detection Order

Subject-Verb → Tense → Pronoun → Article/Determiner → Preposition → Modifier → Parallelism → Vocabulary/Collocation

⚡ Trick

For a long sentence, first locate the **main subject + main verb + object/complement**. Then inspect the likely error zones.

20. Mixed Grammar Errors

A sentence may contain more than one possible-looking problem. Identify the error that actually violates standard grammar or the intended meaning.

Example:

The students of this class **is** preparing for the test.

Main error → **is**

Correction → **are**

The phrase **of this class** does not change the plural subject **students**.

21. Sentence Arrangement

Sentence arrangement requires you to put sentences or parts into a logical sequence.

21.1 Opening Sentence

A likely opening sentence often:

- introduces the topic
- introduces the person/thing
- gives the general background
- does not depend on an earlier reference

A sentence beginning with **he, she, this, that, these, such, therefore** is often unlikely to be the first sentence if its reference has not yet been introduced.

21.2 Pronoun Link

Ravi entered the room. **He** sat down.

The sentence introducing Ravi normally precedes the sentence beginning with **he**.

21.3 Demonstrative Link

Words such as **this, that, these, those, such** often refer to an earlier idea or noun.

21.4 Connector Link

- however → contrast
- therefore → result
- moreover → addition
- consequently → result
- finally → concluding stage

⚡ Trick

Look for **mandatory pairs** before trying every possible order. If one sentence clearly explains “this”, find the sentence that introduces the relevant idea.

22. Chronological Order

When events occur over time, use the sequence:

first → then → next → after that → finally

Other clues include dates, ages, stages, and time expressions.

23. Cause and Effect

Common pattern:

Cause → Result

It rained heavily. **Therefore**, the match was cancelled.

Result markers

therefore, hence, thus, consequently, as a result

Cause markers

because, since, as, due to, owing to

💡 Exam Tip

A result marker normally connects an effect to an earlier cause or explanation.

24. Contrast and Continuation

Contrast

however, but, although, nevertheless, whereas, yet

Addition

moreover, furthermore, also, in addition, besides

⚠ Trap

However normally signals a contrast with a preceding idea. Do not automatically make it the first sentence of a paragraph.

25. Advanced Sentence Arrangement Technique

Use a **link-chain** approach:

Opening → Noun introduction → Pronoun/reference → Explanation → Result/example → Conclusion

Strong clues

1. Full name → pronoun
2. General statement → specific example
3. Cause → effect
4. Question → answer/explanation
5. Problem → solution
6. First event → later event
7. Claim → evidence

∴ strategy If options are given as sequences, find a strong pair first. Once one pair is fixed, eliminate sequences that break that pair. ∴

26. Question Formation

Correct question structure is useful in sentence correction and transformation.

Yes/No Questions

Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb...?

Does he work here?

WH Questions

WH-word + Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb...?

Where does he live?

⚠ Trap

After an auxiliary such as **do/does/did**, use V1:

⊗ Where did he went?

✓ Where did he go?

27. Negative Sentence Formation

Common patterns:

- Present simple → do/does not + V1
- Past simple → did not + V1
- Be verb → be + not
- Modal → modal + not + V1
- Perfect → have/has/had + not + V3

Examples:

He does not work here.
She did not go.
He cannot swim.
They have not finished.

28. Punctuation Basics for Sentence Ability

Basic punctuation can affect sentence clarity.

Full Stop

Ends a statement.

Comma

Separates items, introductory elements, or clauses in appropriate constructions.

Apostrophe

Shows possession or contraction.

- Ravi's book
- don't = do not

Question Mark

Used after a direct question.

Where are you going?

Quotation Marks

Used for direct speech in standard English writing.

⚠ Warning

Do not confuse an apostrophe for possession with a plural marker: **book's** does not normally mean "books".

29. Common Sentence Ability Traps

Trap

Trap 1 — Nearest noun

The nearest noun is not necessarily the subject.

Trap 2 — Direct translation

Hindi sentence order does not always map directly to English.

Trap 3 — Familiar option

A familiar word may still be grammatically or contextually wrong.

Trap 4 — Connector without reference

However, therefore, this, that, and such often depend on earlier context.

Trap 5 — Pronoun before antecedent

A pronoun may be unclear when its reference has not been established.

Trap 6 — Double comparison

more better / most tallest.

Trap 7 — Redundancy

return back / repeat again / discuss about.

Trap 8 — Collocation

A word can be grammatically possible but unnatural with the surrounding words.

Trap 9 — No improvement

Do not alter a sentence merely to make it different.

30. Quick Correction Bank

Incorrect	Correct	Rule
He do his work.	He does his work.	agreement
Did she went?	Did she go?	did + V1
He can sings.	He can sing.	modal + V1
She has went home.	She has gone home.	perfect + V3
an university	a university	sound
a hour	an hour	sound
much students	many students	countability
He discussed about it.	He discussed it.	discuss + object
Between you and I	Between you and me	object form
more better	better	comparison
most tallest	tallest	comparison
reading, to write, dancing	reading, writing, dancing	parallelism
He is senior than me.	He is senior to me.	usage
return back	return	redundancy
repeat again	repeat	redundancy

31. Hindi Help — Fast Identification

Task	Ask yourself
Subject	Who/what controls the verb?
Object	Who/what receives the action?
Tense	When/how is the action expressed?
Article	General or specific? What sound follows?
Preposition	Which fixed combination is required?
Improvement	Is the alternative grammatically and contextually better?
Error	Which exact rule is broken?
Arrangement	Which sentence introduces and which sentence refers?
Connector	Cause, result, contrast, or addition?

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32. Practice Set — Sentence Ability

Practice

Section A — Correction

1. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He do his work daily.
- B. He does his work daily.
- C. He doing his work daily.
- D. He did his work daily every day.

2. Did she ___ the letter?

- A. wrote B. writes C. write D. writing

3. Everyone ___ present.

- A. are B. were C. is D. have

4. He is good ___ English.

- A. in B. at C. on D. by

5. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. She is more better than me.
- B. She is better than me.
- C. She is most better than me.
- D. She is very better than me.

6. Choose the correct article: He is ___ honest man.

- A. a B. an C. the D. no article

7. Choose the correct form: She has ___ home.

- A. went B. go C. gone D. going

8. Choose the parallel sentence.

- A. She likes reading, to write and dancing.
- B. She likes reading, writing and dancing.
- C. She likes to reading, writing and dance.
- D. She likes read, writing and dancing.

9. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He discussed about the problem.
- B. He discussed the problem.

C. He discussed on the problem.

D. He discussed for the problem.

10. The quality of these products ___ good.

A. are B. were C. is D. have

Section B — Sentence Improvement

11. He is senior ___ me.

A. than B. to C. from D. with

12. She returned ___ home.

A. back B. again C. to back D. no additional word

13. Choose the best form: He discussed ___ the issue.

A. about B. on C. for D. no preposition

14. Choose the best sentence.

A. She is more better now.

B. She is better now.

C. She is most better now.

D. She is very better now.

15. Choose the correct form: He wanted to study, ___, and travel.

A. working B. worked C. work D. to working

Section C — Fill in the Blanks

16. She has lived here ___ 2020.

A. for B. since C. during D. by

17. There are ___ students in the room.

A. much B. many C. little D. a little

18. The instructions were very ___, so everyone understood them.

A. clear B. careless C. hostile D. reluctant

19. He ___ a decision after careful thought.

A. did B. made C. paid D. took up

20. She is ___ honest person.

A. a B. an C. the D. no article

Section D — Arrangement

21. Arrange the sentences:

- A. He opened the book.
- B. Ravi sat at his desk.
- C. He began to read.

- A. A-B-C
- B. B-A-C
- C. C-A-B
- D. B-C-A

22. Which is usually the best opening sentence?

- A. This surprised everyone.
- B. He then entered the room.
- C. Ravi entered the room.
- D. Therefore, they left.

23. Which connector normally signals a result?

- A. However
- B. Although
- C. Therefore
- D. But

24. Which connector most clearly signals contrast?

- A. therefore
- B. however
- C. consequently
- D. hence

25. In an arrangement, which usually comes first?

- A. He, when the person has not been introduced
- B. This, when the idea has not been introduced
- C. The sentence introducing the main topic
- D. Therefore, without a previous cause

Section E — Mixed Ability

26. Choose the correct question.

- A. Where did he went?
- B. Where did he go?
- C. Where he did go?
- D. Where did he going?

27. Choose the correct negative sentence.

- A. She did not went.
- B. She did not goes.
- C. She did not go.
- D. She not did go.

28. Identify the error: "The quality of these products are excellent."

- A. quality
- B. these
- C. are
- D. excellent

29. Choose the correct collocation.

- A. do a decision
- B. make a decision
- C. pay a decision
- D. give a decision

30. Choose the correct indirect-question form.

- A. He asked where was I going.
- B. He asked where I was going.
- C. He asked where am I going.
- D. He asked where going I was.

31. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Between you and I, this is true.
- B. Between you and me, this is true.
- C. Between you and myself, this is true.
- D. Between you and mine, this is true.

32. Choose the correct article.

- A. a hour
- B. an hour
- C. the hour always
- D. an university

33. Choose the correct sentence.



- A. She looks beautifully.
- B. She looks beautiful.
- C. She looks beauty.
- D. She looks beautify.

34. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He can swims well.
- B. He can swim well.
- C. He can swimming well.
- D. He can swam well.

35. Choose the best correction: "He returned back yesterday."

- A. He returned yesterday.
- B. He returned back again yesterday.
- C. He did returned yesterday.
- D. He returning yesterday.

36. Choose the sentence with correct parallelism.

- A. She likes reading, to write and dancing.
- B. She likes reading, writing and dancing.
- C. She likes read, writing and dance.
- D. She likes to reading, writing and dancing.

37. Choose the best connector: "It was raining heavily; ____, the match was cancelled."

- A. however
- B. therefore
- C. although
- D. meanwhile

38. Choose the correct form: "Everyone ____ their work."

- A. have completed
- B. has completed
- C. are completing
- D. were complete

39. Which sentence is most likely to be the opening sentence of an arrangement?

- A. This was unexpected.
- B. Therefore, the plan failed.
- C. The committee announced a new plan.
- D. He then explained it.

40. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. She has seen him yesterday.
- B. She saw him yesterday.
- C. She had saw him yesterday.
- D. She has seeing him yesterday.

41. Choose the correct word: "He is interested ___ science."

- A. on B. at C. in D. for

42. Choose the correct word: "The students ___ ready."

- A. is B. are C. was D. has

43. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He asked where was she going.
- B. He asked where she was going.
- C. He asked where is she going.
- D. He asked where going she was.

44. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Repeat again the answer.
- B. Repeat the answer.
- C. Repeat back again the answer.
- D. Repeated again the answer.

45. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He discussed about the matter.
- B. He discussed the matter.
- C. He discussed on the matter.
- D. He discussed for the matter.

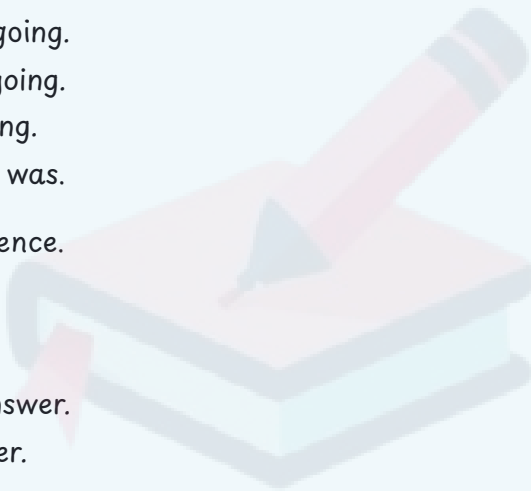
46. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. She is good in English.
- B. She is good at English.
- C. She is good on English.
- D. She is good by English.

47. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Neither the teacher nor the students is ready.
- B. Neither the teacher nor the students are ready.
- C. Neither the teacher or the students are ready.
- D. Neither teacher nor students is ready always.

48. Choose the correct sentence.



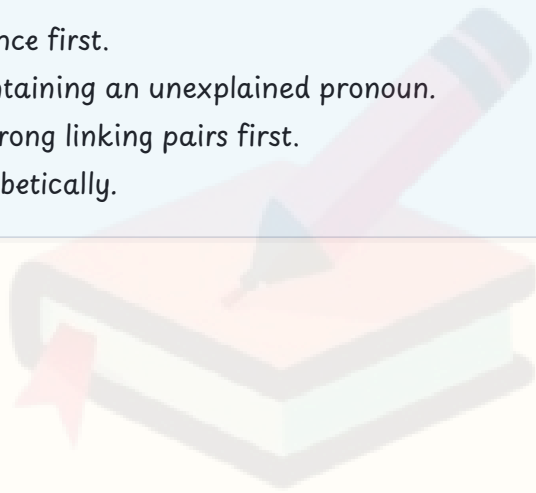
- A. I have been waiting for two hours.
- B. I have been waiting since two hours.
- C. I am waiting since two hours.
- D. I waited since two hours.

49. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He entered into the room.
- B. He entered the room.
- C. He entered in the room.
- D. He did entered the room.

50. Choose the best strategy for a difficult sentence-arrangement question.

- A. Choose the longest sentence first.
- B. Start with a sentence containing an unexplained pronoun.
- C. Find opening clues and strong linking pairs first.
- D. Arrange sentences alphabetically.



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33. Answer Key

Q	Ans	Key Point
1	B	agreement
2	C	did + V1
3	C	everyone → singular
4	B	good at
5	B	no double comparison
6	B	vowel sound
7	C	perfect + V3
8	B	parallelism
9	B	discuss + object
10	C	subject = quality
11	B	senior to
12	D	return already includes the idea
13	D	discuss + object
14	B	better
15	C	parallel V1 forms
16	B	since + starting point
17	B	many + countable plural
18	A	context
19	B	make a decision
20	B	vowel sound
21	B	introduction → action → result

Q	Ans	Key Point
22	C	topic introduction
23	C	result
24	B	contrast
25	C	opening sentence
26	B	did + V1
27	C	did not + V1
28	C	subject = quality
29	B	collocation
30	B	statement word order
31	B	object form
32	B	vowel sound
33	B	linking verb + adjective
34	B	modal + V1
35	A	remove redundancy
36	B	parallelism
37	B	result
38	B	everyone + singular verb
39	C	topic introduction
40	B	finished past time
41	C	interested in
42	B	plural subject
43	B	indirect-question word order
44	B	remove redundancy
45	B	discuss + object

Q	Ans	Key Point
46	B	good at
47	B	nearest subject in common exam construction
48	A	for + duration
49	B	enter + object
50	C	strong-link method

Remember

Sentence Ability Formula:

Grammar + Meaning + Context + Collocation + Logical Order = Correct Sentence

For PET, first master the rule, then apply it to correction, improvement, fillers, error detection, and arrangement questions.

General English — Reading Comprehension

PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

Focus: Main Idea → Facts → Inference → Vocabulary → Title → Reference → Purpose → Tone → Advanced Question Patterns → Practice

Hindi Help: Short support is provided only for difficult reading logic.

1. What is Reading Comprehension?

Reading comprehension is the ability to understand a passage, identify important information, interpret the writer's meaning, and answer questions using evidence from the text.

PET comprehension questions may test:

- Main idea / central theme
- Specific facts and details

- Inference and conclusion
- Vocabulary in context
- Synonym/antonym in context
- Suitable title
- Reference of a word/phrase
- Cause and effect
- Sequence/order
- Writer's purpose
- Author's viewpoint
- Tone
- True / False / Not stated style questions
- EXCEPT / NOT / INCORRECT questions
- Sentence-level meaning

 Exam Tip

Golden Rule: The passage is the primary source of evidence. Do not select an answer simply because it is generally true or because you already know something about the topic.

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2. Question-Type Master Table

Question Type	What it asks	Main approach
Main Idea	central message	whole passage
Central Theme	broad subject/message	repeated idea + conclusion
Detail/Fact	explicitly stated information	locate evidence
Inference	reasonable conclusion	evidence + logic
Vocabulary	meaning in context	surrounding words
Synonym	closest contextual meaning	substitution test
Antonym	opposite contextual meaning	exact contextual sense
Title	best overall heading	main idea + scope
Reference	what a word refers to	grammar + logic
Cause/Effect	reason/result	connectors + relationships
Sequence	first/next/last	time markers
Purpose	why information is included	function of passage
Viewpoint	writer's position	repeated claims + language
Tone	writer's attitude	evaluative language
True/False	whether statement agrees	direct comparison
Not Stated	information absent	evidence check
NOT/EXCEPT	statement that does not fit	verify every option
Sentence Meaning	meaning of a specific line	local + paragraph context

3. How to Read a Passage

Step 1 — Preview

Read the title, opening sentence, and, when useful, scan the question set.

Step 2 — Identify the subject

Ask: **Who/what** is this passage about?

Step 3 — Track the development

Look for:

- topic sentence
- explanation
- evidence
- example
- contrast
- cause/effect
- conclusion

Step 4 — Notice connectors

Important connectors include:

however, therefore, because, although, moreover, consequently, for example, finally.

Step 5 — Build a mental map

Topic → Main claim → Supporting points → Conclusion

∴ strategy **Read → Understand → Locate evidence → Eliminate → Answer**

Do not depend on memory alone when the passage is available. ∴

4. Question-First vs Passage-First Strategy

There is no single method for every passage.

Passage-first

Useful when the passage is short or the topic is unfamiliar.

Question-first

Useful when the passage is longer and questions ask for specific details.

Hybrid Method

For PET, a practical approach is:

1. Quickly understand the topic.
2. Scan the questions.
3. Return to the passage for evidence.
4. Read the relevant paragraph carefully.

Exam Tip

Do not follow a strategy rigidly. **Accuracy and textual evidence matter more than the order in which you read.**

5. Main Idea vs Central Theme

Main idea = the central point the writer communicates.

Central theme = the broader subject or message developed throughout the passage.

Example

A passage discusses how regular exercise improves physical health, mood, sleep, and concentration.

- **Topic:** Exercise
- **Central theme:** Benefits of regular physical activity

- **Main idea:** Regular physical activity has several important benefits for overall well-being.

Trap

A single example, statistic, person, or minor benefit is usually too narrow to represent the main idea or title.

6. Finding the Main Idea

Look for:

1. Repeated concepts
2. Topic sentence
3. Supporting examples
4. Final conclusion
5. Relationship between paragraphs

Trick

Ask: “If I had to explain the whole passage in one sentence, what would I say?”

7. Fact and Detail Questions

A fact/detail question asks for information directly stated or clearly presented.

Method

1. Identify the keyword.
2. Locate it or its synonym in the passage.
3. Read the surrounding sentence(s).
4. Match the option with the evidence.
5. Reject options that add unsupported information.

Warning

A statement may be true in real life but still be wrong if the passage does not support it.

8. Inference Questions

An inference is a conclusion reasonably supported by the passage. It is not a guess or outside knowledge.

Evidence Ladder

Textual fact → logical connection → reasonable conclusion

∴ strategy Ask: **“What is strongly suggested by the evidence?”** rather than “What could possibly be true?” ∴

9. Direct vs Inferred Information

Direct	Inferred
explicitly stated	logically concluded
little interpretation needed	some reasoning required
words/details appear in text	meaning follows from evidence

10. Negative Inference Questions

Questions may ask:

- Which cannot be inferred?
- Which is NOT implied?
- Which statement is least supported?

Method

1. Treat every option as a claim.
2. Find evidence for each.
3. Eliminate clearly supported options.

4. Choose the option with no reasonable textual support.

⚠️ Trap

Do not choose an option merely because it is unlikely in real life. It must be unsupported by the passage.

11. Vocabulary in Context

A word can have different meanings in different contexts.

Context Method

1. Read the complete sentence.
2. Read before and after it.
3. Identify the part of speech.
4. Substitute each option mentally.
5. Choose the meaning that fits the passage.

The scientist **observed** a change in the sample.

Here **observed** means **noticed/watched carefully**.

💡 Exam Tip

Choose the contextual meaning, not the first dictionary meaning you remember.

12. Synonym and Antonym Questions in a Passage

For passage-based vocabulary questions, do not use an isolated vocabulary list alone.

Synonym

Choose the option that can replace the word without changing the intended meaning.

Antonym

Choose the option that expresses the appropriate opposite meaning in that context.

∴ strategy **Part of speech + context + replacement test = safer vocabulary answer.** ∴

13. Reference Questions

Common reference words:

- it
- they
- he/she
- this
- that
- these
- those
- such
- former/latter



Method

1. Look backward first.
2. Identify grammatically possible antecedents.
3. Check number/person agreement.
4. Check logical meaning.

The city introduced electric buses. **This** reduced pollution.

This refers to the introduction/use of electric buses described earlier.

⚠ Trap

The nearest noun is not automatically the correct reference.

14. Suitable Title

The best title should:

- represent the whole passage
- capture the central idea
- be concise
- avoid unsupported information

Title Test

Ask: “Does this title cover most of the passage, not just one paragraph?”

⚡ Trick

Best Title ≈ Main Idea in a short form.

15. Cause and Effect

Common cause markers:

- because
- since
- due to
- owing to
- as

Common effect markers:

- therefore
- hence
- thus
- consequently
- as a result

The river overflowed **because of** continuous rainfall.

Cause → continuous rainfall

Effect → river overflow

16. Sequence and Chronology

Look for:

- first
- initially
- then
- next
- later
- afterwards
- finally
- eventually

::: strategy Create a simple mental timeline instead of memorising every sentence word-for-word. :::

17. Writer's Purpose

The writer may intend primarily to:

- inform
- explain
- describe
- compare
- persuade
- warn
- criticize
- suggest
- evaluate

Purpose Test

Ask: **"What job is the passage doing?"**

The purpose should be inferred from the whole passage, not one sentence.

18. Author's Viewpoint

Viewpoint is the position or perspective from which the writer discusses a subject.

Look for:

- repeated claims
- recommendations
- criticism
- praise
- qualifications
- comparison between alternatives

Exam Tip

Do not infer the author's viewpoint from the topic alone. A passage about technology may be supportive, critical, balanced, or cautious.

19. Tone

Tone is the writer's attitude.

Common tones:

- neutral
- informative
- positive
- critical
- concerned
- optimistic
- pessimistic
- appreciative
- cautious
- skeptical
- encouraging

Look at adjectives, verbs, evaluations, recommendations, and repeated emotional signals.

⚠ Warning

Topic ≠ Tone. “Pollution” is a topic; “concerned” or “critical” may describe tone.

20. Fact vs Opinion

Fact

Information that can generally be verified.

Opinion

Belief, judgment, recommendation, or evaluation.

Possible signals include:

- should
- best
- worst
- excellent
- terrible
- I believe
- in my view

Always judge the complete sentence and context.

21. True / False / Not Stated

- **True:** clearly supported by the passage.
- **False:** contradicted by the passage.
- **Not Stated:** neither clearly supported nor contradicted.

⚠ Trap

Not stated ≠ false. If the passage simply does not provide enough information, do not invent a contradiction.

22. NOT / EXCEPT / INCORRECT Questions

Watch for:

- NOT
- EXCEPT
- FALSE
- INCORRECT
- CANNOT
- NOT TRUE

Method

1. Highlight the negative word mentally.
2. Check every option against the passage.
3. Mark supported options.
4. Select the option matching the question's negative requirement.

⚠ Warning

Many mistakes happen because students find a true option when the question actually asks for the false/incorrect one.

23. Sentence-Level Meaning

Sometimes a question asks what a particular sentence means or implies.

Method

1. Read the target sentence.
2. Read one sentence before and after it.
3. Identify pronouns and connectors.
4. Restate it in simpler English.
5. Choose the option closest to that meaning.

∴ strategy Do not interpret a sentence in isolation when its meaning depends on surrounding context. ∴

24. Option Elimination

Eliminate options that are:

1. **Contradictory** — passage says the opposite.
2. **Unsupported** — no evidence.
3. **Too extreme** — stronger than the text.
4. **Too narrow** — only one small detail.
5. **Partly correct** — supported beginning + unsupported addition.
6. **Off-topic** — related words but wrong question focus.

Formula

Best answer = Supported + Relevant + Complete + Correctly worded

25. Extreme Words

Be cautious with:

- always
- never
- all
- none
- completely
- only
- must
- impossible

They are not automatically wrong, but require strong textual support.

26. Paragraph Mapping

For longer passages, mentally label:

- **P1:** introduction/topic

- **P2:** explanation/evidence
- **P3:** example/contrast
- **P4:** conclusion/solution

Use the actual passage structure; this is only a mental model.

⚡ Trick

Keyword → Paragraph → Evidence is faster than rereading the complete passage for every detail question.

27. Passage Length Strategy

Short Passage

- Read the complete passage carefully.
- Identify the central idea.
- Answer directly from evidence.

Medium Passage

- Track paragraph purpose.
- Notice contrasts and examples.
- Return to relevant sections.

Long Passage

- Build a paragraph map.
- Scan questions for keywords.
- Locate evidence efficiently.
- Avoid unnecessary rereading.

28. Difficult Vocabulary During Reading

You do not need to understand every word.

If a word is unfamiliar:

1. Ignore it temporarily.
2. Read surrounding context.
3. Determine whether it affects the question.
4. Infer meaning if necessary.
5. Return only if required.

Exam Tip

One unknown word should not stop the entire passage. Understand the overall meaning first.

29. Reading Speed vs Accuracy

Improve speed by:

- reading meaningful word groups
- recognising connectors
- locating keywords
- avoiding unnecessary rereading
- practising regularly

Improve accuracy by:

- checking negative words
- returning to evidence
- separating fact from inference
- rejecting extreme options
- verifying the exact question requirement

30. Common Comprehension Traps

Trap

Trap 1 — Outside Knowledge

The option is true generally but unsupported by the passage.

Trap 2 — Detail as Main Idea

A minor fact is selected as the central message.

Trap 3 — Extreme Option

The option is stronger than the passage's wording.

Trap 4 — Half-Correct Option

One part is supported, another is invented.

Trap 5 — Reference Error

A nearby noun is selected without checking logic.

Trap 6 — Negative Question

NOT/EXCEPT/INCORRECT is overlooked.

Trap 7 — Not Stated = False

Lack of information is incorrectly treated as contradiction.

Trap 8 — Tone by Topic

The subject is mistaken for the writer's attitude.

31. Hindi Help — Quick Reading Map

Question	Hindi clue
Main Idea	पूरे passage का मुख्य विचार
Theme	passage का व्यापक विषय/संदेश
Fact	passage में सीधे क्या बताया गया?
Inference	जानकारी से क्या निष्कर्ष निकलता है?
Vocabulary	context में word का अर्थ
Title	पूरे passage का सबसे उपयुक्त शीर्षक
Reference	this/it/they किसके लिए है?
Cause	कारण क्या है?
Effect	परिणाम क्या है?
Purpose	writer यह क्यों बता रहा है?
Tone	writer का attitude कैसा है?
Not Stated	passage में जानकारी नहीं दी गई

32. Solved Mini Passage — Main Idea

Passage

Regular physical activity can improve several aspects of health. It can strengthen the body, support better sleep, and improve mood. Even moderate activity, when performed regularly, can contribute to a healthier lifestyle.

Question

What is the main idea?

- A. Sleep is the only benefit of exercise.
- B. Regular physical activity has several health benefits.
- C. Only intense exercise is useful.
- D. Exercise is difficult for everyone.

Answer: B

Why? Several benefits are discussed; sleep is only one detail.

33. Solved Mini Passage — Inference

Passage

The village had received very little rainfall for several months. The wells were drying up, and farmers had begun using water carefully for crops.

Question

What can reasonably be inferred?

- A. The village was experiencing water scarcity.
- B. The village received record rainfall.
- C. All crops had already failed.
- D. The farmers stopped working completely.

Answer: A

Reason: Low rainfall + drying wells + careful water use support the inference.

34. Solved Mini Passage — Vocabulary

Passage

The teacher gave a **brief** explanation before the test began.

Question

The word **brief** most nearly means:

- A. lengthy
- B. short
- C. confusing
- D. difficult

Answer: B

35. Solved Mini Passage — Reference

Passage

The city planted more trees along major roads. **This** helped reduce dust and improve the local environment.

Question

What does **This** refer to?

- A. major roads
- B. dust
- C. planting more trees
- D. the local environment

Answer: C

36. Solved Mini Passage — Title

Passage

Digital payments have become increasingly common. They can make transactions faster and reduce the need to carry cash. However, users should remain careful about passwords, suspicious links, and fraudulent messages.

Question

Which is the most suitable title?

- A. Why Cash Should Disappear Completely
- B. Digital Payments: Benefits and Safety
- C. The History of Banks
- D. Problems With Mobile Phones

Answer: B

37. Solved Mini Passage — Not Stated

Passage

The school introduced a reading period every Friday. Students may use the library during this period, and teachers encourage them to choose books according to their interests.

Question

Which statement is **NOT stated**?

- A. The reading period is held every Friday.
- B. Students may use the library.
- C. Teachers encourage students to choose books according to their interests.
- D. Students receive marks for every book they read.

Answer: D

Why? The passage does not mention marks for reading books.

38. Solved Mini Passage — Tone / Viewpoint

Passage

Online learning can make educational material accessible to students who live far from major institutions. However, reliable internet access and self-discipline remain important challenges. Therefore, online learning can be valuable, but it works best when learners have appropriate support and resources.

Questions

1. What is the writer's viewpoint?

- A. Completely against online learning
- B. Completely in favour without any limitation
- C. Balanced, recognising benefits and challenges
- D. Unrelated to online learning

Answer: C

2. The tone is best described as:

- A. balanced/cautious
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. celebratory

Answer: A

39. Full Practice Passage 1

Passage

Trees play an important role in maintaining a healthy environment. They absorb carbon dioxide, release oxygen, provide shade, and support many forms of wildlife. Trees can also help reduce soil erosion by holding soil together with their roots. In urban areas, planting trees can make streets more comfortable and improve the appearance of public spaces. For these reasons, protecting existing trees and increasing green cover are important environmental measures.

Questions

1. What is the main idea?

- A. Trees are useful only in cities.
- B. Trees provide several environmental benefits and should be protected.
- C. Wildlife is the only reason to plant trees.
- D. Trees prevent all environmental problems.

2. Which benefit is mentioned?

- A. Increasing soil erosion
- B. Reducing oxygen

- C. Providing shade
 - D. Eliminating all pollution
3. How can trees reduce soil erosion?
- A. By increasing rainfall
 - B. By holding soil with their roots
 - C. By removing wildlife
 - D. By covering roads
4. What can be inferred about urban trees?
- A. They can contribute to more comfortable public spaces.
 - B. They are harmful to cities.
 - C. They are useful only for wildlife.
 - D. They have no environmental role.
5. Which title is most suitable?
- A. The Many Benefits of Trees
 - B. Roads and Buildings
 - C. Wildlife Without Trees
 - D. Problems With Soil

40. Full Practice Passage 2

Passage

Many students believe that studying for long hours automatically produces better results. However, the quality of study is often more important than the number of hours spent at a desk. A focused study session with clear goals, short breaks, and active recall can be more useful than several hours of distracted reading. Regular revision also helps students retain information over time. Therefore, an effective study routine should emphasise concentration, active learning, and consistent revision rather than simply increasing study hours.

Questions

6. What is the main point?
- A. Students should study without breaks.
 - B. Longer study hours always guarantee success.
 - C. Effective study depends on quality, active learning, and consistency.
 - D. Reading is the only useful study method.

7. What may be more useful than distracted reading?

- A. A focused study session with clear goals.
- B. Studying all night.
- C. Avoiding revision.
- D. Increasing distractions.

8. What does active recall represent here?

- A. Passive rereading only.
- B. An active learning approach.
- C. Taking longer breaks.
- D. Avoiding tests.

9. Why is regular revision useful?

- A. It helps retain information over time.
- B. It eliminates the need to study.
- C. It increases distractions.
- D. It makes every session longer.

10. Which title best fits the passage?

- A. Study Longer at Any Cost
- B. Effective Study: Quality Over Mere Hours
- C. Why Students Should Avoid Revision
- D. The History of Education

41. Full Practice Passage 3

Passage

Public libraries continue to serve communities even as digital resources become more widely available. A library provides access to books, newspapers, educational material, and sometimes computers or internet facilities. It can also offer a quiet place for study and learning. For students who may not have suitable study resources at home, such facilities can be especially valuable. Digital technology has changed how people access information, but it has not removed the need for shared public learning spaces.

Questions

11. What is the central idea?

- A. Digital technology has made libraries useless.
- B. Public libraries continue to provide valuable learning resources and spaces.
- C. Libraries contain only newspapers.
- D. Students should never use digital resources.

12. Which facility is mentioned?

- A. Sports stadiums
- B. Computers or internet facilities
- C. Hospitals
- D. Transport services

13. Why may libraries be especially valuable for some students?

- A. They provide suitable study resources and spaces.
- B. They guarantee exam success.
- C. They replace teachers completely.
- D. They prevent access to digital information.

14. What does “such facilities” refer to?

- A. Digital technology only
- B. Study resources and facilities provided by libraries
- C. Newspapers only
- D. Homes

15. Which statement is supported?

- A. Digital resources have completely replaced libraries.
- B. Libraries can still function as shared public learning spaces.
- C. Libraries are useful only for children.
- D. Libraries provide no access to technology.

42. Full Practice Passage 4

Passage

Water conservation is not only a responsibility of large institutions. Households can also reduce unnecessary water use through simple habits such as repairing leaking taps, using water carefully while washing, and reusing suitable water for plants. These actions may appear small individually, but when adopted by many households they can reduce wastage significantly. Conservation therefore depends both on public systems and on responsible everyday behaviour.

Questions

16. What is the central message?

- A. Only institutions can conserve water.
- B. Household habits can contribute meaningfully to water conservation.
- C. Water conservation requires expensive technology in every home.
- D. Small actions have no value.

17. Which action is mentioned?

- A. Leaving taps open
- B. Repairing leaking taps
- C. Increasing water wastage
- D. Avoiding plants

18. What can be inferred?

- A. Collective small actions can have a significant effect.
- B. Household behaviour never matters.
- C. Public systems are unnecessary.
- D. Water conservation is impossible.

19. The phrase “these actions” refers to:

- A. public systems only
- B. everyday water-saving habits
- C. institutions
- D. expensive technology

20. Which title is best?

- A. Water Conservation: Everyday Responsibility
- B. Why Water Should Be Wasted
- C. Large Institutions Only
- D. The History of Water

43. Full Practice Passage 5

Passage

Public transport can reduce the number of private vehicles on roads when it is reliable, affordable, and convenient. Buses and trains can carry many passengers at once, potentially reducing traffic pressure and fuel consumption per passenger. However, simply increasing the number of vehicles is not enough. Public transport systems also require good scheduling, maintenance, safety, and convenient connections so that people are willing to use them regularly.

Questions

21. What is the main idea?

- A. Public transport is useful only when it is expensive.
- B. Effective public transport can reduce road pressure when supported by reliable services.

- C. Private vehicles should never be used.
- D. More buses alone solve every transport problem.

22. Which condition is mentioned as important?

- A. Unreliable service
- B. High fares only
- C. Good scheduling and maintenance
- D. Fewer connections

23. Why can buses and trains reduce traffic pressure?

- A. They carry many passengers at once.
- B. They increase private vehicles.
- C. They stop all road traffic.
- D. They remove the need for roads.

24. Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Reliability can affect willingness to use public transport.
- B. Maintenance is important.
- C. Simply increasing vehicle numbers is always sufficient.
- D. Convenient connections can encourage use.

25. The writer's tone is best described as:

- A. balanced and practical
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. completely dismissive

44. Full Practice Passage 6

Passage

Reading fiction can provide entertainment, but its value may extend beyond relaxation. Stories can expose readers to unfamiliar situations, perspectives, and emotions. By following characters with different experiences, readers may develop greater awareness of how other people think and feel. This does not mean that every story produces the same effect, but regular engagement with varied narratives can encourage reflection and empathy.

Questions

26. What is the main idea?

- A. Fiction is useful only for entertainment.

- B. Fiction can provide entertainment and may also encourage perspective-taking and empathy.
- C. Every story produces exactly the same effect.
- D. Fiction should replace all other forms of learning.

27. What may stories expose readers to?

- A. Only familiar situations
- B. Unfamiliar situations, perspectives, and emotions
- C. Only factual information
- D. Only historical dates

28. What does "This" in the passage refer to?

- A. Reading only for entertainment
- B. The possibility that stories can develop awareness of other people's perspectives
- C. Every story producing the same effect
- D. Avoiding varied narratives

29. Which statement is supported?

- A. Every fiction reader becomes empathetic.
- B. Varied narratives can encourage reflection and empathy.
- C. Fiction has no value beyond relaxation.
- D. Stories cannot influence perspective.

30. Which title is most suitable?

- A. Fiction: Entertainment and Perspective
- B. Why Every Story Is Identical
- C. Reading Without Reflection
- D. The End of Fiction

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45. Answer Key — Full Practice

Q	Ans	Skill
1	B	Main idea
2	C	Fact
3	B	Detail
4	A	Inference
5	A	Title
6	C	Main idea
7	A	Detail
8	B	Context
9	A	Detail
10	B	Title
11	B	Main idea
12	B	Fact
13	A	Inference/detail
14	B	Reference
15	B	Supported statement
16	B	Main idea
17	B	Fact
18	A	Inference
19	B	Reference
20	A	Title
21	B	Main idea

Q	Ans	Skill
22	C	Detail
23	A	Cause/effect
24	C	NOT supported
25	A	Tone
26	B	Main idea
27	B	Detail
28	B	Reference
29	B	Supported statement
30	A	Title

46. Advanced Mixed Practice — Question Patterns

Passage A

Community gardens can transform unused urban spaces into productive and social areas. Residents may grow vegetables, flowers, and herbs while also meeting neighbours and learning basic gardening skills. Such gardens do not solve every urban problem, but they can contribute to local food awareness, community interaction, and greener surroundings.

31. The main idea is:

- A. Community gardens solve every urban problem.
- B. Community gardens can provide several environmental and social benefits.
- C. Urban residents should grow only vegetables.
- D. Gardening is mainly a commercial activity.

32. What does “Such gardens” refer to?

- A. unused spaces
- B. community gardens

- C. urban problems
- D. vegetables

33. Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Gardens may encourage interaction among residents.
- B. Gardens may provide learning opportunities.
- C. Gardens completely solve urban problems.
- D. Gardens can make surroundings greener.

34. The writer's viewpoint is best described as:

- A. positive but qualified
- B. completely negative
- C. unrelated
- D. sarcastic

Passage B

Many people assume that taking notes means writing down nearly everything a speaker says. Effective notes, however, usually involve selecting important ideas, organising them clearly, and using short forms where appropriate. The purpose of note-taking is not to create a complete transcript but to create a useful record that helps later recall.

35. What is the main point?

- A. Every spoken word should be written down.
- B. Effective note-taking involves selecting and organising important information.
- C. Short forms should never be used.
- D. Note-taking is unnecessary.

36. What does "**however**" signal?

- A. addition
- B. contrast
- C. cause
- D. sequence

37. According to the passage, the purpose of note-taking is to:

- A. create a complete transcript
- B. help later recall through a useful record
- C. copy every sentence exactly
- D. avoid organising information

38. Which statement is most strongly supported?

- A. More words always mean better notes.
- B. Selective notes can be more useful than a complete transcript.
- C. Note-taking requires no judgment.
- D. Speakers should pause after every sentence.

Passage C

A town introduced a bicycle-sharing programme near major transit stations. During the first few months, usage was modest because many residents were unfamiliar with the system. After clearer signs were installed and information about membership became easier to access, more people began using the bicycles. The change suggests that convenience and information can influence whether people adopt a new public service.

39. Why was early usage modest?

- A. Bicycles were unavailable.
- B. Residents were unfamiliar with the system.
- C. Transit stations were closed.
- D. Membership was compulsory.

40. What happened after clearer signs and information were provided?

- A. Usage increased.
- B. The programme ended.
- C. Stations were removed.
- D. Residents stopped cycling.

41. What can reasonably be inferred?

- A. Information and convenience may affect adoption of a service.
- B. All residents prefer bicycles.
- C. Signs alone guarantee success.
- D. Public services never need promotion.

42. Which title is most suitable?

- A. Factors Affecting Adoption of a Bicycle-Sharing Service
- B. Why Bicycles Are Dangerous
- C. The History of Transit Stations
- D. Membership Fees Only

Passage D

A museum exhibition compared traditional tools with modern automated equipment. Rather than presenting one as universally superior, the exhibition showed how different tools suit different tasks. Traditional tools may offer simplicity and direct control, while automated systems can increase speed and consistency. The exhibition therefore encouraged visitors to think about suitability rather than assuming that newer technology is always better.

43. What is the central message?

- A. Traditional tools are always better.
- B. Modern equipment is always better.
- C. The appropriate tool depends on the task.
- D. Museums should avoid technology.

44. The tone is:

- A. balanced and analytical
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. fearful

45. What does “one” refer to in “Rather than presenting one as universally superior”?

- A. one task
- B. either type of tool
- C. one museum
- D. one visitor

46. Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Traditional tools may provide direct control.
- B. Automated systems may increase speed.
- C. Newer technology is always better.
- D. Different tasks may require different tools.

47. Advanced Practice Answer Key

Q	Ans	Skill
31	B	Main idea
32	B	Reference
33	C	NOT supported
34	A	Viewpoint/tone
35	B	Main idea
36	B	Connector/contrast
37	B	Detail
38	B	Inference
39	B	Fact
40	A	Fact
41	A	Inference
42	A	Title
43	C	Central message
44	A	Tone
45	B	Reference
46	C	NOT supported

48. Final Reading Strategy

Remember

Before reading

Understand the topic and question requirement.

While reading

Follow the main idea, paragraph purpose, connectors, examples, contrasts, and conclusions.

While answering

Locate evidence, eliminate unsupported/extreme options, and distinguish fact from inference.

Before marking

Check whether the question asks **TRUE, FALSE, NOT, EXCEPT, or INCORRECT**.

49. Quick Revision Checklist

- ☐ Identify the main idea.
- ☐ Distinguish main idea from central theme.
- ☐ Separate main idea from supporting details.
- ☐ Locate explicit facts.
- ☐ Make only evidence-based inferences.
- ☐ Handle negative inference questions carefully.
- ☐ Use context for vocabulary.
- ☐ Solve contextual synonym/antonym questions.
- ☐ Trace pronoun/reference words.
- ☐ Select a title covering the whole passage.
- ☐ Identify cause and effect.
- ☐ Follow chronological order.
- ☐ Identify writer's purpose and viewpoint.

- Recognise tone.
- Distinguish fact, opinion, and not-stated information.
- Watch negative question words.
- Eliminate extreme/unsupported options.
- Adjust strategy according to passage length.

Formula

Reading Comprehension Formula:

Understand → Map → Locate evidence → Eliminate traps → Verify → Answer



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